NHMEC

Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

MODULE 5

Teaching Herbal Education in Your Community

Module Overview

One of the greatest gifts a Community Herbalist can offer is education.

Teaching others how to safely use herbs, grow medicinal plants, prepare herbal remedies, and appreciate God's creation creates a lasting impact that reaches beyond a single individual. Every class taught, every herb walk led, and every educational conversation has the potential to strengthen families and communities.

A Community Herbalist is not expected to know everything. Instead, they are called to become lifelong learners who communicate accurately, ethically, and with humility.

This module focuses on developing the skills needed to confidently educate individuals and groups while remaining within an educational scope of practice.

Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module, students will be able to:

• Identify characteristics of an effective herbal educator.

• Develop confidence in public speaking.

• Plan educational workshops.

• Organize engaging herbal demonstrations.

• Teach within ethical and legal boundaries.

• Create educational handouts and visual aids.

• Adapt teaching methods for different audiences.

Required Reading

Read the sections of the **Community Herbalist eGuide** related to:

• Community Education

• Teaching Herbal Knowledge

• Outreach and Public Engagement

• Sharing Traditional Herbal Wisdom

• Community Leadership

As you read, identify examples of:

• Effective communication

• Leadership

• Encouragement

• Community service

• Responsible education

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module you should understand that teaching herbalism is not about impressing people with knowledge—it is about helping others learn safely, confidently, and responsibly.

Instructor Lecture

The Community Herbalist as Teacher

Teaching has always been central to preserving herbal traditions.

Long before books, herbal knowledge was passed from generation to generation through observation, storytelling, apprenticeships, and hands-on practice.

Today, Community Herbalists continue this tradition by teaching others how to safely identify plants, prepare simple herbal remedies, and cultivate a greater appreciation for the natural world.

Teaching is not about having all the answers. It is about guiding others toward lifelong learning.

Teaching with Humility

An effective educator understands that learning never ends.

Good teachers:

Continue studying.

Welcome questions.

Research unfamiliar topics.

Admit when they do not know an answer.

Respect differing viewpoints.

Remain teachable themselves.

Humility builds trust.

Knowing Your Audience

Every audience learns differently.

Children learn through:

Stories

Hands-on activities

Games

Nature exploration

Adults often appreciate:

Demonstrations

Discussion

Printed materials

Questions and answers

Senior adults often enjoy:

Traditional herbal stories

Practical demonstrations

Printed handouts

Shared experiences

Community Herbalists adapt their teaching style to meet the needs of their audience.

Planning an Herbal Workshop

Every successful workshop begins with preparation.

A simple workshop outline includes:

Welcome

Introduction

Learning objectives

Presentation

Demonstration

Questions

Summary

Resources

Closing

Well-planned classes create confidence for both the instructor and the students.

Using Demonstrations

People remember what they experience.

Examples include:

Making herbal tea

Preparing infused oils

Creating herbal salves

Plant identification

Drying herbs

Seed planting

Label reading

Hands-on activities increase learning and encourage participation.

Educational Materials

Community Herbalists often create:

Fact sheets

Recipe cards

Plant identification guides

Herbal journals

Worksheets

PowerPoint presentations

Reference notebooks

Resource lists

Good educational materials should be accurate, easy to read, visually appealing, and appropriate for beginners.

Ethical Communication

Community Herbalists educate rather than diagnose or prescribe.

Avoid making claims that herbs cure diseases or replace professional medical care.

Instead, focus on:

Traditional uses

Historical information

Preparation methods

Botanical identification

Healthy lifestyle education

Safety considerations

Always encourage students to seek qualified medical advice when appropriate.

Public Speaking Tips

Many new educators feel nervous.

Remember:

Speak slowly.

Smile.

Maintain eye contact.

Practice beforehand.

Know your material.

Invite questions.

Be yourself.

Confidence grows with experience.

Biblical Reflection

Proverbs 9:9 (KJV)

"Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be yet wiser: teach a just man, and he will increase in learning."

Teaching is one of the greatest ways we can serve others. By sharing knowledge with humility and wisdom, Community Herbalists help others become better stewards of their health and of God's creation.

Vocabulary

Define the following:

Facilitation

Workshop

Demonstration

Presentation

Audience

Visual Aid

Educational Outreach

Public Speaking

Learning Objectives

Communication

Reflection Questions

1. What qualities make an excellent teacher?
2. What fears do you have about public speaking?
3. Which audience would you most enjoy teaching?
4. Why is humility important in education?
5. How can demonstrations improve learning?
6. What topics would you most enjoy teaching?
7. How will you continue learning after completing this diploma?

Practical Activity

Observe an Educator

Attend a class, webinar, workshop, church lesson, or educational event.

Observe:

Teaching style

Organization

Audience participation

Visual aids

Communication

Strengths

Areas for improvement

Write a one-page summary of your observations.

Workshop Planning Exercise

Design a 30-minute beginner herbal workshop.

Include:

Workshop title

Learning objectives

Target audience

Materials needed

Outline

Hands-on activity

Safety discussion

Question-and-answer session

Closing summary

Assignment

Create a Beginner Herbal Class

Develop a complete lesson plan for a one-hour educational class.

Choose one topic:

Introduction to Herbal Tea

Kitchen Herbs

Medicinal Herb Gardening

Herbal First Aid

Herbal Safety

Growing Culinary Herbs

Seasonal Wellness Herbs

Your lesson plan should include:

Introduction

Learning objectives

Teaching outline

Discussion questions

Demonstration

Handout

Homework assignment

Resources

Estimated teaching time

Minimum length:

6–8 pages.

Mini Quiz

1. The primary goal of a Community Herbalist when teaching is to:

A. Diagnose illness

B. Empower others through education

C. Sell products

D. Replace physicians

1. Effective demonstrations help students:

A. Memorize facts only

B. Learn through hands-on experience

C. Avoid participation

D. Skip reading

1. Good educators should:

A. Pretend to know everything

B. Continue learning throughout life

C. Avoid questions

D. Teach without preparation

1. Educational materials should be:

A. Confusing

B. Accurate and easy to understand

C. Filled with medical claims

D. Difficult to read

1. Public speaking confidence improves primarily through:

A. Avoiding audiences

B. Practice and preparation

C. Reading silently

D. Speaking quickly

Answer Key

1. B
2. B
3. B
4. B
5. B

Module Project

Develop Your Community Herbal Workshop Kit

Prepare a complete educational teaching kit.

Include:

Workshop lesson plan

Instructor notes

PowerPoint outline

Student handout

Plant identification sheet

Recipe card

Supply list

Evaluation form

Completion certificate

Promotional flyer

This project should be professional enough to present at a church, library, community center, or farmers market.

Community Herbal Journal

Record:

Three teaching topics you would enjoy presenting.

Two local organizations where you could teach.

Five ways you can improve your communication skills.

One educational goal for the next year.

Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading completed

☐ Vocabulary completed

☐ Reflection questions answered

☐ Educational observation completed

☐ Workshop outline completed

☐ One-hour lesson plan submitted

☐ Community Workshop Kit created

☐ Quiz passed (80% or higher)

☐ Herbal Journal updated

Instructor Challenge (Optional)

Teach a 15-minute herbal lesson to a friend, family member, church group, homeschool co-op, or community organization.

Afterward, ask participants for feedback by answering:

• What did you learn?

• What was most helpful?

• What would you like to learn next?

Reflect on their responses and identify three ways you can improve as an educator.

Looking Ahead

In **Module 6**, you will begin building one of the most valuable resources a Community Herbalist can create—a **Community Herbal Resource Library**. You will learn how to develop plant monographs, herb journals, educational reference binders, recipe collections, and resource materials that can be used for teaching, outreach, and lifelong learning.